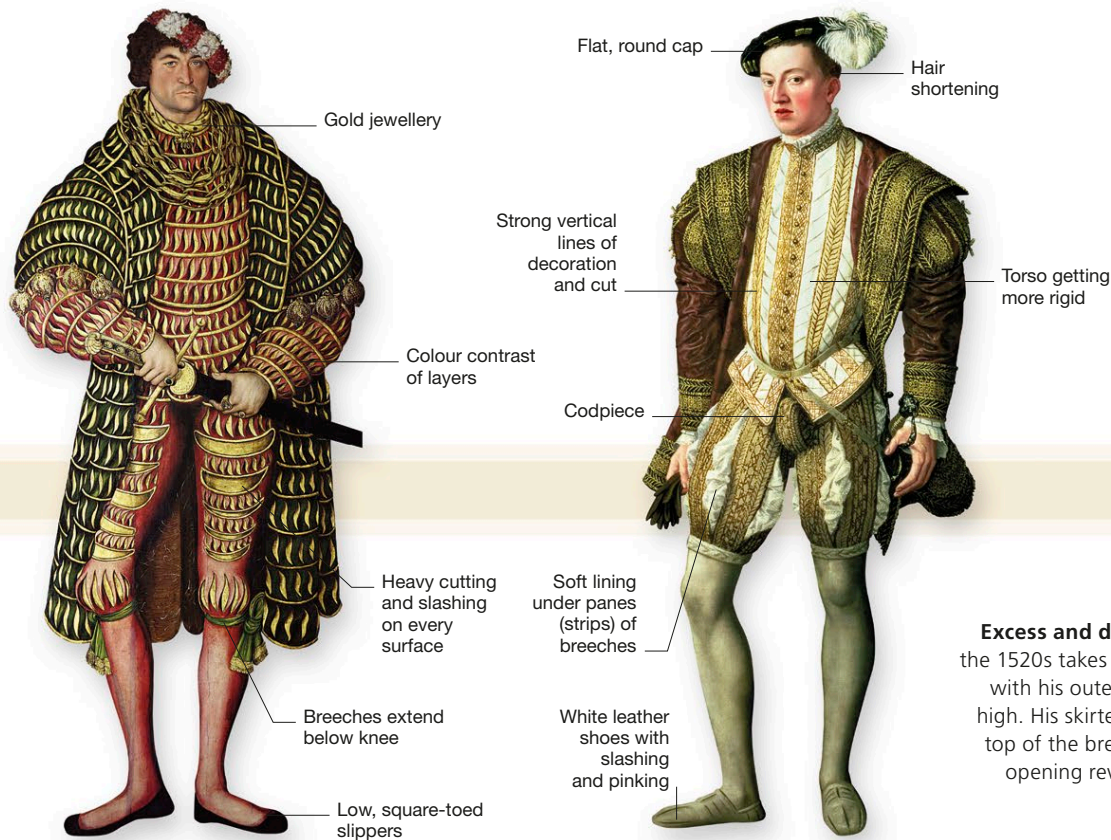
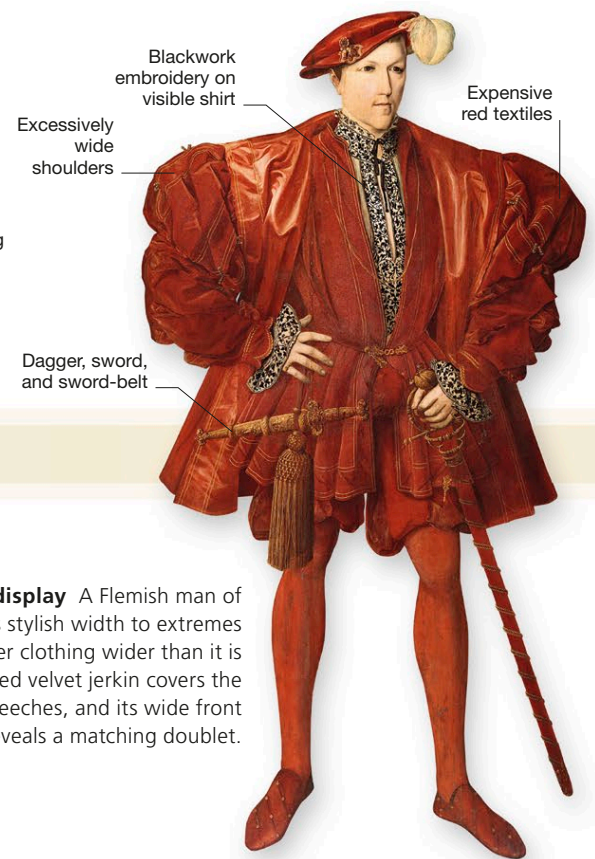




Fashionable slashing It is thought the craze for slitting clothing surfaces came from soldiers cutting plundered garments to make them fit. In this 1514 portrait, Henry IV, Duke of Saxony, wears a whole suit slashed to reveal the inner lining.

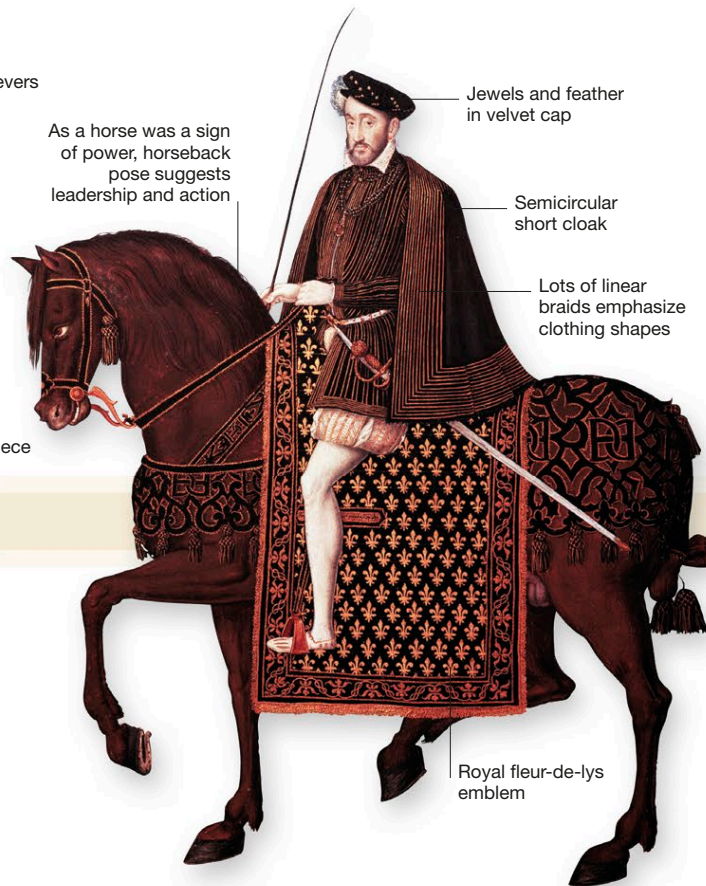
Focus on thighs Breeches or upper hose ranged in fit from skintight to extremely loose and baggy. By 1548 the jerkin skirts on Archduke Ferdinand of Tirol had shrunk into small panes, flaunting the codpiece and thighs.



Excess and display A Flemish man of the 1520s takes stylish width to extremes with his outer clothing wider than it is high. His skirted velvet jerkin covers the top of the breeches, and its wide front opening reveals a matching doublet.



Paned decoration In this reconstruction, the deep U-shaped jerkin front goes over a doublet made of fabric panes (strips) joined by buttons. The sleeves are also made of panes.



Monochrome monarch Henri II of France, one of the age's dominant personalities, exploited the stark drama of black and white, with severe gold decoration, in a mid-16th-century portrait of sovereign power.

THE CODPIECE



The origins of the codpiece lie in the triangle of fabric used to join the two separate hose legs in the late 15th century when doublets shortened. Soon padding was added and ended up as the codpiece – a prominent, suggestive shape filling the gap between the legs of the breeches. It soon became a normal part of male clothing, in style across many countries and social levels until the end of the 1500s. Tailors became as creative with codpiece shapes as with other clothing details. The codpiece could hide a pocket or even be used as a pincushion.